Ziad Hares

Chief Technology Officer, Begad · Founder, Computator Technology

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SUMMARY

Chief Technology Officer of Begad, a bilingual UAE marketplace (begad.ae) on PHP 8.3, MariaDB and AWS, and founder of Computator Technology, a Dubai DET-licensed software and managed-IT practice. Final-year BSc Cybersecurity student (UOWD, graduating Dec 2026). At Begad: fixed revenue-critical payment and stock defects, rebuilt ad attribution, shipped iOS/Android apps and recovered the platform from git after its production instance was deleted. Background in penetration testing, ISO 27001 governance, hardened self-hosted infrastructure (WireGuard, Matrix E2EE, Traefik, Proxmox) and local-first AI systems. Comfortable owning a production system end to end: threat model, build, deploy, recover.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer · Begad General Trading L.L.C (begad.ae) · Dubai, UAE — Aug 2026 – Present

- Own technology for a bilingual UAE marketplace end to end: platform engineering, AWS infrastructure, payments, mobile apps, analytics and security, with 2,400+ production commits across storefront, checkout, wallet, seller payouts, logistics tracking, admin and seller portals.
- Closed revenue leaks: orders were confirmed and stock deducted before Stripe capture; gated confirmation strictly post-payment and added Stripe Payment Element (Apple/Google Pay) and Tabby BNPL.
- Rebuilt ad attribution from zero e-commerce events to full-funnel Meta Conversions API + TikTok Events API with event_id deduplication and SHA-256 hashed match data.
- Restored the platform from git history after the production instance was deleted with no backups (Aug 2026); then introduced versioned migrations, automated backups, GitHub Actions CI/CD and infrastructure runbooks.
- Cut UAE page latency: CloudFront origin keep-alive tuning, tracking-parameter cache normalisation, stale-while-revalidate page caches and edge caching of guest and signed-in pages.
- Shipped iOS/Android apps (Capacitor with native Swift/Java bridges), an iMessage extension, and a public agent API (catalog, search, product, MCP tools, llms.txt) so AI assistants can shop the catalogue.
- Launched vidvie.ae, the UAE distributor site for the VIDVIE brand, fed live from the Begad API; private S3 + CloudFront, GitHub OIDC deploys with no stored keys, Route 53 DNS.
- Set direction for Begad's mobile launch, Libya market expansion and agent-commerce roadmap under a 12-month engineering agreement (Sep 2026).

Founder & Lead Engineer · Computator Technology · Dubai, UAE — Aug 2026 – Present

- Run a Dubai DET-licensed sole establishment delivering websites, custom software and managed IT; engineering partner to Begad and smaller UAE and Libyan clients.
- Built computator.ae on React 19, Vite and Tailwind v4 with a PHP API and serialized, verified, auto-rollback GitHub Actions deployments; delivered client sites including Al Reemas Center (bilingual AR/EN with a 36-concept logo lab).

Lead Engineer (contract) · BHF Auctions · Dubai, UAE — May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built a luxury auction platform on Next.js 15, Prisma and MariaDB with Pusher real-time bidding and bilingual catalogue support.
- Engineered deterministic proxy bidding, an immutable bid ledger, reconciliation and signed close reports; wrote rehearsal scripts to audit ledger consistency under concurrent bidding.
- Designed the encrypted KYC data lifecycle, point-in-time recovery runbooks and an off-server recovery drill (Jul 2026); purged a leaked credential from repository history.
- Authored the full technical handoff: architecture, roadmap, quality and security gates, operations and restart checklist.

Technology & Growth Lead · Mon Adoptive Technology · Dubai, UAE — May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Led the SME Solutions Division: ERP/CRM implementation offer, six-month business plan and executive strategy for the owner, corporate portal, and client proposals including a nightclub CRM and a hardened-device and secure-router offering.
- Built the Mon Maison real-estate intelligence platform: consolidated 23M+ owner and property rows from hundreds of source files with deduplication and entity resolution, Telegram (Telethon MTProto) and WhatsApp ingestion, and a local AI research assistant.
- Developed Komissio, a local-first company operating system (FastAPI, React, SQLite, ChromaDB) piloted at Mon Maison; customised ERPNext; automated a live stock portfolio with EODHD market data and generated Excel/VBA workbooks.

Backend Development & Security Intern · Tamam · Sharjah, UAE — Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Built Python and SQL data-collection pipelines and multi-area vendor scrapers with input validation, sanitisation and rate-limit handling.
- Implemented access control, SQL-injection prevention and query optimisation on the backend database.

IT Security Intern · NewBridge Pharmaceuticals · Dubai, UAE — Jun 2025 – Jul 2025

- Drafted security policies aligned with ISO/IEC 27001 (including third-party cybersecurity policy), a risk register and a remediation plan; supported risk assessment and awareness initiatives.

Web Security & Development Intern · Axon Technologies · Dubai, UAE — Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

- Redesigned and delivered the company website with OWASP-aligned front-end controls (input validation, XSS prevention) and performance improvements.

E-Commerce Development Intern · Armada Holdings · Dubai, UAE — Dec 2022 – Apr 2023

- Contributed to the Yalla Bazzar e-commerce platform: inventory and customer data workflows, front-end UX and access control.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Kontraktus · local-first contract intelligence platform (UOWD capstone) — May 2026 – Oct 2026

- Python/Streamlit app that parses, indexes and analyses contracts entirely on-device with zero network egress: Ollama (Qwen 2.5), bge-small embeddings, ChromaDB + BM25 hybrid retrieval with reciprocal rank fusion, clause-aware chunking with verbatim citations, YAML risk rules, missing-clause detection, Tesseract OCR; retrieval evaluated on 102 lawyer-labelled CUAD contracts.

Self-hosted secure communications stack — 2026

- WireGuard VPN with admin dashboard, Matrix Synapse homeserver with end-to-end encryption and Matrix Authentication Service (OAuth2/OIDC SSO), LiveKit WebRTC, Traefik with Let's Encrypt, Glance SSO dashboard, Netdata monitoring, encrypted DNS and an E2EE ops bot; scripted, repeatable deployments.

Homelab, pentest range & OSINT self-audit dashboard — 2024 – Present

- Proxmox VE with segmented attack/target subnets (Kali, Metasploitable, Windows Server), OpenWrt firewall and WireGuard segment; Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite and Wireshark practice. Dockerised LXC dashboard combining Maigret, Sherlock, WhatsMyName, Holehe and PhoneInfoga with image EXIF/OCR auditing; Traefik routing and NFS storage.

Client websites — 2024 – 2026

- Al Reemas Center (Libyan gold importer: bilingual AR/EN site and 36-concept logo lab), VIDVIE UAE, Amal Al Khaleej, Axon Technologies, Yalla Bazzar, professional portfolios and small-business sites on GitHub Pages and AWS.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity · University of Wollongong in Dubai — Sep 2023 – Dec 2026 (expected)

Coursework: Ethical Hacking, Network Security, System Security, Information Security Management, Database Systems (Oracle PL/SQL), Software Development Methodologies, Capstone Project. Member, UOWD Cybersecurity Club (CTF practice) since 2024.

American High School Diploma · Pioneers International School, Alexandria, Egypt — Sep 2018 – Jun 2022

ACT 23 · GPA 3.8

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS, Nikto, Hydra; OWASP Top 10, CSP/HSTS hardening, JWT, OAuth2/OIDC, encrypted data lifecycles; ISO/IEC 27001 policies, risk treatment, CVSS triage, incident runbooks

Infrastructure & DevOps: Linux (Debian, Ubuntu, Kali), Proxmox VE, Docker/Podman, Traefik, WireGuard, Matrix Synapse, LiveKit, Netdata; AWS (EC2, ALB, CloudFront, S3, Route 53, RDS, IAM/OIDC, SSM), GitHub Actions CI/CD, backups and point-in-time recovery

Languages: Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, PHP 8, SQL, Bash, C/C++; Swift and Java for mobile bridges

Web & mobile: React 19, Next.js 15, Vite, Tailwind CSS v4, Node.js, FastAPI, Prisma, Pusher WebSockets, Capacitor, bilingual RTL/LTR interfaces, Stripe and Tabby integrations

Data & AI: PostgreSQL, MariaDB, SQLite, Oracle PL/SQL, DuckDB; Ollama, ChromaDB, hybrid BM25/vector retrieval, Tesseract OCR, Telethon; entity resolution and deduplication at scale; Excel/VBA automation

Tools: Git, Claude Code and multi-agent workflows, Figma, Microsoft 365

LANGUAGES

Arabic (native) · English (proficient)